Reading and writing

2026-10-29 | Week 3 | Characters take action

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.9C

3.9C: Discuss elements of drama such as characters, dialogue, setting, and acts. In plain English: Recognize and discuss the characters, spoken lines, setting and acts in a play. Today: Use dialogue and character roles to act the pumpkin problem and solution.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.8A

4.8A: Infer basic themes supported by text evidence. In plain English: Work out a story's message and support it with evidence from the text. Today: Support a message about teamwork with the pumpkin-pulling scene.

I Do

Grade 3: Open Big Pumpkin to the matching scene. Say, "We are learning to act the problem and solution using character speech." Use small pumpkin, character figures, ribbon for a pretend vine to model one response, then point to the page that supports it. Grade 4: Open Big Pumpkin to the matching scene. Say, "We are learning to support a message about teamwork with the pumpkin-pulling scene." Use small pumpkin, character figures, ribbon for a pretend vine to model one response, then point to the page that supports it.

We Do

Read the scene aloud again. Each learner moves the character props to show the problem, action and result. Ask the Grade 3 learner to retell the events; ask the Grade 4 learner why the action matters. Fade the model; return to the real illustrations before accepting an answer. Open the current HMH drama excerpt to identify character names and dialogue; then apply those features when acting Big Pumpkin.

You Do

Grade 3: Act the problem and solution using character speech. Grade 4: Support a message about teamwork with the pumpkin-pulling scene. Use one fresh question from a familiar page. Record the response, page/scene and help used.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Match familiar props or photos from the already taught scene, sequence two mastered event photos, or use a known Vizzle task. Independent reading is not assumed.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Real books: Big Pumpkin. Bring the props and response mats in the weekly book guide.

Writing TEKS 3.7B

Write a response to a literary or informational text that demonstrates an understanding of a text.

Writing TEKS 4.7B

Write responses that demonstrate understanding of texts, including comparing and contrasting ideas across a variety of sources.

Writing and spelling

After the read-aloud, build one sentence from the evidence: Grade 3 retells an event; Grade 4 explains a character's action with a because statement. Keep HMH phonics/spelling at the assessed pattern; teach three words before Friday's spelling check. Writing TEKS 3.7B / 4.7B: compose a response to the actual text. Dictation or AAC composition is an access option; record the response method. Matching a picture alone is reading evidence, not independent written composition. For Grade 4, add an alike/different sentence comparing an idea in today's book with a previously read book; point to evidence in both sources.

8-9 AM read-aloud

Big Pumpkin by Erica Silverman. Return to the real pages for evidence; see the weekly book guide.

Math

2026-10-29 | Week 3 | Characters take action

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.5E

3.5E: Represent real-world relationships using number pairs in a table and verbal descriptions. In plain English: Use pairs of numbers in a table to describe a real-world relationship. Today: Build 4 bags with 2 supplies each; complete 4 / 8 in the table and explain the relationship.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.5C, 4.5D

4.5C: Use models to determine the formulas for the perimeter of a rectangle (l + w + l + w or 2l + 2w), including the special form for perimeter of a square (4s) and the area of a rectangle (l x w). In plain English: Use models to explain rectangle area and perimeter formulas. 4.5D: Solve problems related to perimeter and area of rectangles where dimensions are whole numbers. In plain English: Solve rectangle area and perimeter problems with whole-number side lengths. Today: Build a 2 by 4 rectangle; show area 8 square units and perimeter 12 units.

I Do

Grade 3: Put 2 supplies in each bag. Build a two-column table: 1 bag / 2 supplies, 2 bags / 4 supplies, 3 bags / 6 supplies. Explain the relationship: two supplies for each bag. Grade 4: Cover a 2 by 3 rectangle with 6 unit squares. Trace and count the 10 unit edges around the outside.

We Do

Both students handle the shared materials. Practice one example with the teacher; then teach the two targets in separate rotations. Grade 4: connect the 2-by-3 tile model to A = 2 x 3 and P = 2 + 3 + 2 + 3. Use the model to explain why area multiplies rows and columns and perimeter adds all four edges.

You Do

Grade 3: Build 4 bags with 2 supplies each; complete 4 / 8 in the table and explain the relationship. Grade 4: Build a 2 by 4 rectangle; show area 8 square units and perimeter 12 units.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Complete a mastered counting/sorting tray or known Bridges practice task at the student's established level.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Counters, plates/cups and the linked math mat. Select the matching grade-level STEMscopes lesson. Use Bridges placement to choose a separate foundational intervention.

Science

2026-10-29 | Week 3 | Characters take action

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8A

3.8A: Identify everyday examples of energy, including light, sound, thermal, and mechanical. In plain English: Recognize everyday examples of light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. Today: Identify light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.8A, 4.8B, 4.8C

4.8A: Investigate and identify the transfer of energy by objects in motion, waves in water, and sound. In plain English: Investigate how moving objects, water waves and sound transfer energy. 4.8B: Identify conductors and insulators of thermal and electrical energy. In plain English: Identify materials that let heat or electricity pass through and materials that resist it. 4.8C: Demonstrate and describe how electrical energy travels in a closed path that can produce light and thermal energy. In plain English: Show that electricity travels around a closed path and can produce light and heat. Today: Observe energy transfer, test materials and build a closed circuit.

I Do

Grade 3: Show a flashlight, shaker, safely lukewarm sealed bottle and moving car. Name light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. Grade 4: Use moving cars, sound, thermal conductors and a low-voltage battery circuit to observe transfer. Close the path to light a bulb; open it to stop.

We Do

Predict with objects or pictures, test together, then identify what changed. Keep one test variable different and other relevant conditions the same.

You Do

Grade 3: Match an object to its energy form; demonstrate one observable change. Grade 4: Show a transfer or closed circuit and identify what changed.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Sort familiar object/photo matches away from the experiment station. Experiments are adult supervised.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

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Materials

Two puppets or figures, counters, square tiles, flashlight, shaker, battery circuit kit. Adult manages circuit parts, magnets, small items and warm materials; use a low-voltage kit only.

Social studies

2026-10-29 | Week 3 | Characters take action

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.9C

3.9C: Identify and describe individual acts of civic responsibility, including obeying laws, serving and improving the community, serving on a jury, and voting. In plain English: Describe civic responsibilities such as following laws, helping the community, jury service and voting. Today: Choose a helpful action and explain its effect.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.2B

4.2B: Identify the accomplishments and explain the impact of significant explorers, including Cabeza de Vaca; Francisco Coronado; and René Robert Cavelier, Sieur de la Salle, on the settlement of Texas. In plain English: Explain named explorers' accomplishments and their effects on Texas settlement. Today: Explain one effect of an explorer's actions.

I Do

Grade 3: Choose a helpful action and explain its effect. Model with one district source, naming the visible clue. Grade 4: Explain one effect of an explorer's actions. Use the current Texas history map, image or excerpt; name the person/event and point to the evidence.

We Do

Work together with a second example from the same source set. One picture + one dictated sentence or symbol-based response. Keep the grade-specific question visible and fade added hints.

You Do

Grade 3: Choose a helpful action and explain its effect. Grade 4: Explain one effect of an explorer's actions. Use a fresh source/card; accept a model, pointing, AAC or a spoken explanation.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Match two familiar source pictures or complete a known picture-to-object task.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

District source pictures or excerpts, two-event sequence mat and writing/history frames. The classroom texts do not replace Texas history sources.